Building Inspection Report – Structural

Job No: BAA 242022

At: 10 Riddle Street
Bentleigh VIC 3204

For: John Smith

Date: 24 July 2022

Client Brief

We are instructed to prepare a report which comments on whether any maintenance items or building defects exist which are of a structural nature and present an immediate risk to safety.

The items addressed in this report are only those which pose an immediate risk to safety.

Unrestricted access was provided to the site, however due to the state of repair, no access to the roof cavities was provided.

We report as follows:

Five immediate structural concerns were identified:

1. Front retaining wall brickwork has cracked in the mortar from the pressure of the soil. Discussions with the vendors indicate that this retaining wall has not been altered or repaired since their purchase in 1978. The retaining wall in its current state sits at a lean of 8 degrees towards the street. There is an immediate risk of structural failure as a result the age and wear exerted on the retaining wall.

2. Front porch overhead roof cover is constructed of concrete which is covered in rendered cement. The rendered cement has worn away exposing the concrete which has significant cracks. Discussions with the vendors indicate that no repairs or maintenance have been conducted on this concrete slab since their purchase in 1978. This concrete is at immediate risk of failure due to the lack of support afforded.

3. Rear retaining wall brickwork has cracked in the mortar approximately one third of the way from the left-hand side of construction from the pressure of the soil. Discussions with the vendors indicate that this retaining wall had previously collapsed in 1997 and had been self-repaired using the existing bricks and a mortar mix from Mitre 10. The retaining wall in its current state sits at a lean of 13 degrees towards the lower section of the yard. There is an immediate risk of structural failure as a result of the poor standard of construction and the wear exerted on the retaining wall.

4. Stairs leading to the loft are heavily worn and warped. The iron frame has significant corrosion and is poorly attached to the structure. There is an immediate risk of collapse should an average male adult (80kgs) use the stairs for their intended purpose.

5. Steel sheeting on the roof of the carport has corroded to the extent that it has holes through the entire thickness of the steel. The extent of damage is such that no weight can be placed safely on the steel without risk of failure.

It was noted that the entire property was in a poor state of repair. In addition to the items listed above, the majority of the property requires significant repair in order to comply with the relevant provisions of the NCC and Australian Standards. A registered builder should be engaged to provide information on aspects of construction outside of the scope of this report.

Jason Bourne

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